

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 40

LEVEL A • WORKSHEET

Worksheet: From Room-Sized Machines to Your Pocket

Comprehension + Vocabulary Tasks — based on the article on the history of computers

PART A — COMPREHENSION TASKS [20 marks]

A1

True / False / Not Given [7 marks — 1 mark each]

Do the statements below agree with the information in the article? Write:

TRUE — if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE — if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN — if there is no information about this in the article

1. The first computers were built for entertainment and commercial use.

2. ENIAC used binary code to store and process data.

3. The transistor was invented before the Second World War ended.

4. An integrated circuit combines multiple transistors on a single chip of semiconductor material.

5. Moore's Law states that the number of transistors on a chip doubles approximately every two years.

6. The iPhone was the very first mobile phone ever produced.

7. AI tools capable of writing professional-level text reached 100 million users faster than the internet reached 2 billion users.

Note Completion [9 marks — 1 mark each]

Complete the notes below using **ONE WORD ONLY** from the article for each answer.

Early Computers

8. ENIAC was built in _____ — the same year the Second World War ended.

9. ENIAC weighed around 27 _____ and contained nearly 18,000 vacuum tubes.

10. All data in early computers was stored using _____ code — a system of 0s and 1s.

The Transistor and Chip Revolution

11. The transistor replaced the much larger and less reliable _____ tube.

12. The integrated circuit was created using a piece of _____ material, typically silicon.

13. Gordon Moore predicted that computing power would double approximately every two _____.

The Modern Era

14. The World Wide Web was made public by Tim Berners-Lee in _____.

15. The article describes information stored on remote servers as the _____.

16. AI systems learn from _____ rather than following a fixed set of instructions.

A3

Short Answer Questions [4 marks — 1 mark each]

*Answer these questions in your own words. Write **complete sentences**.*

17. Why does the article describe the transistor as 'the single most important development in the history of computing'?

18. What made personal computers different from the mainframe computers that came before them?

19. How did the internet change the way computers were used, according to the article?

20. What is the key difference between traditional software algorithms and modern AI systems?

B1**Vocabulary Matching [8 marks — 1 mark each]**

Match each word or phrase (1–8) to the correct definition (a–h).

1. transistor	a. all the physical components of a computer — chips, circuits, screens, keyboards	Answer: _____
2. binary code	b. a set of step-by-step instructions that tells a computer how to solve a problem	Answer: _____
3. microprocessor	c. a tiny electronic switch that controls electrical signals in a circuit	Answer: _____
4. mainframe	d. a system that represents all information as a series of 0s and 1s	Answer: _____
5. algorithm	e. a complete computer processor contained on a single silicon chip	Answer: _____
6. hardware	f. a large, expensive computer used by organisations before personal computers existed	Answer: _____
7. software	g. a material such as silicon that can conduct electricity under certain conditions	Answer: _____
8. semiconductor	h. the programs and instructions that tell the hardware what to do	Answer: _____

B2**Gap-Fill [12 marks — 1 mark per gap]**

Complete the sentences using words from the word bank. Some sentences need more than one answer.

WORD BANK

transistor	binary code	microprocessor	mainframe
integrated circuit	operating system	artificial intelligence	processor
algorithm	data storage	programming language	innovation
hardware	software	semiconductor	

9

Early computers stored all information as _____ — a system of 0s and 1s — which remains the fundamental principle of all computing to this day.

10

The invention of the _____ in 1947 replaced the vacuum tube and made it possible to build much smaller and more reliable computers.

11

An _____ combines multiple transistors on a single piece of _____ material, dramatically reducing the size and cost of electronic devices.

12

The first commercial _____ — the Intel 4004 — placed an entire computer _____ on a single chip, making personal computers possible for the first time.

13	Before personal computers existed, only large organisations could afford a _____ — enormous machines that filled entire rooms and cost millions of dollars.
14	An _____ tells a computer how to solve a problem step by step; _____ such as Python allow people to write these instructions in something closer to human language.
15	Every computer needs an _____ — such as Windows or macOS — to manage its _____ and _____ and allow users to run applications.
16	The rise of _____ has brought computers to a new level — these systems learn from data rather than following a fixed set of instructions written by a programmer.
17	The continuous _____ in computer technology over the past seventy years — from vacuum tubes to AI — represents one of the most remarkable periods of progress in human history.